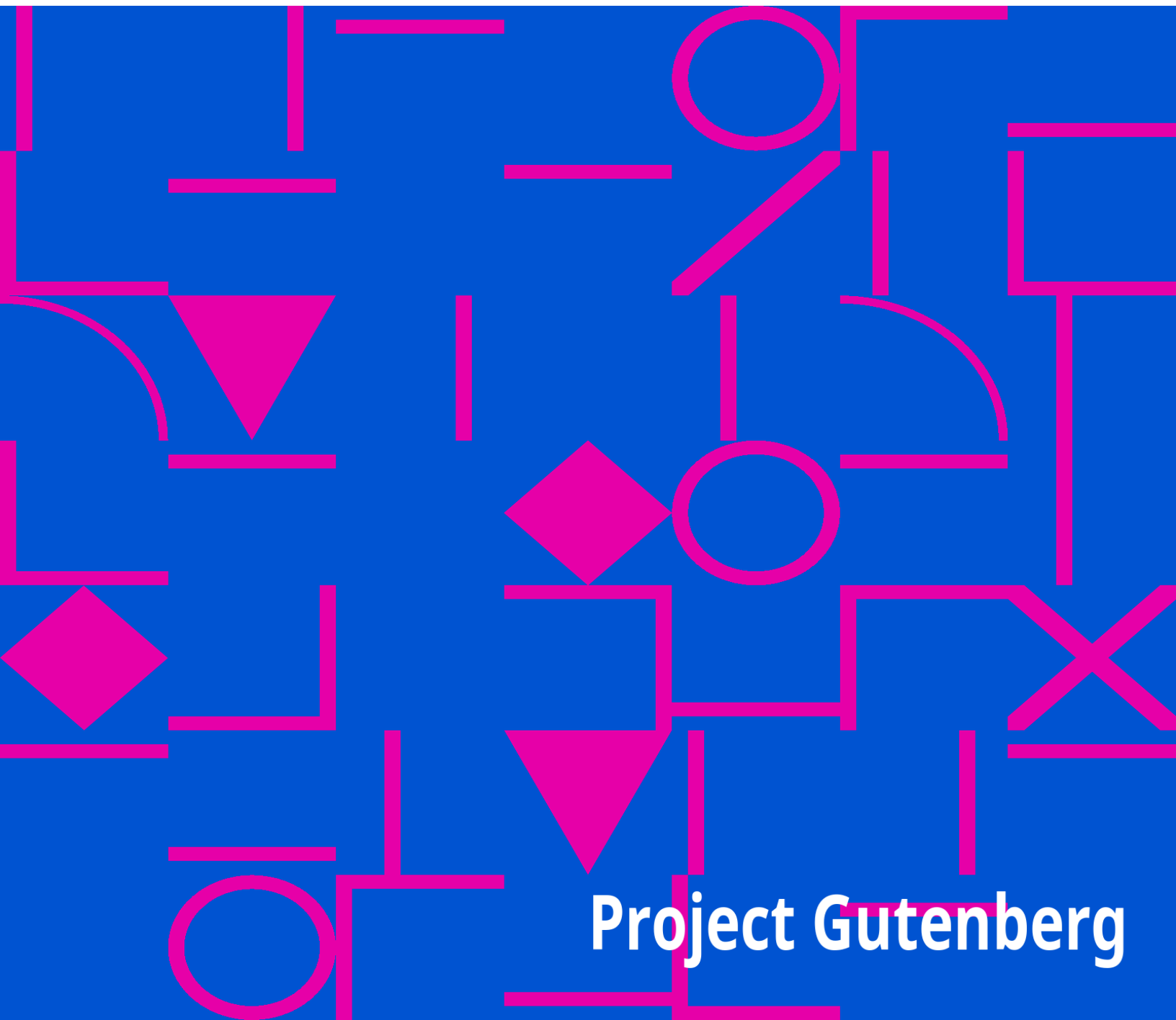


The World English Bible (WEB): Proverbs

Anonymous

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE WORLD
ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB): PROVERBS ***

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**Book 20 Proverbs 001:001 The
proverbs of Solomon, the son of
David, king of Israel: 001:002 to
know wisdom and instruction; to
discern the words of
understanding; 001:003 to receive
instruction in wise dealing, in
righteousness, justice, and equity;
001:004 to give prudence to the
simple, knowledge and discretion to
the young man: 001:005 that the
wise man may hear, and increase in**

**learning; that the man of
understanding may attain to sound
counsel: 001:006 to understand a
proverb, and parables, the words
and riddles of the wise. 001:007
The fear of Yahweh is the
beginning of knowledge; but the
foolish despise wisdom and
instruction. 001:008 My son, listen
to your father's instruction, and
don't forsake your mother's
teaching: 001:009 for they will be a
garland to grace your head, and
chains around your neck. 001:010
My son, if sinners entice you, don't
consent. 001:011 If they say, "Come
with us, Let's lay in wait for blood;
let's lurk secretly for the innocent**

**without cause; 001:012 let's
swallow them up alive like Sheol,
and whole, like those who go down
into the pit. 001:013 We'll find all
valuable wealth. We'll fill our
houses with spoil. 001:014 You shall
cast your lot among us. We'll all
have one purse." 001:015 My son,
don't walk in the way with them.
Keep your foot from their path,
001:016 for their feet run to evil.
They hurry to shed blood. 001:017
For in vain is the net spread in the
sight of any bird: 001:018 but these
lay wait for their own blood. They
lurk secretly for their own lives.
001:019 So are the ways of
everyone who is greedy for gain. It**

takes away the life of its owners.

001:020 Wisdom calls aloud in the street. She utters her voice in the public squares. 001:021 She calls at the head of noisy places. At the entrance of the city gates, she utters her words: 001:022 "How long, you simple ones, will you love simplicity? How long will mockers delight themselves in mockery, and fools hate knowledge? 001:023 Turn at my reproof. Behold, I will pour out my spirit on you. I will make known my words to you.

001:024 Because I have called, and you have refused; I have stretched out my hand, and no one has paid attention; 001:025 but you have

ignored all my counsel, and wanted none of my reproof; 001:026 I also will laugh at your disaster. I will mock when calamity overtakes you; 001:027 when calamity overtakes you like a storm, when your disaster comes on like a whirlwind; when distress and anguish come on you. 001:028 Then will they call on me, but I will not answer. They will seek me diligently, but they will not find me; 001:029 because they hated knowledge, and didn't choose the fear of Yahweh. 001:030 They wanted none of my counsel. They despised all my reproof. 001:031 Therefore they will eat of the fruit

**of their own way, and be filled with
their own schemes. 001:032 For the
backsliding of the simple will kill
them. The careless ease of fools will
destroy them. 001:033 But whoever
listens to me will dwell securely,
and will be at ease, without fear of
harm." 002:001 My son, if you will
receive my words, and store up my
commandments within you;
002:002 So as to turn your ear to
wisdom, and apply your heart to
understanding; 002:003 Yes, if you
call out for discernment, and lift up
your voice for understanding;
002:004 If you seek her as silver,
and search for her as for hidden
treasures: 002:005 then you will**

**understand the fear of Yahweh, and
find the knowledge of God. 002:006
For Yahweh gives wisdom. Out of
his mouth comes knowledge and
understanding. 002:007 He lays up
sound wisdom for the upright. He
is a shield to those who walk in
integrity; 002:008 that he may
guard the paths of justice, and
preserve the way of his saints.
002:009 Then you will understand
righteousness and justice, equity
and every good path. 002:010 For
wisdom will enter into your heart.
Knowledge will be pleasant to your
soul. 002:011 Discretion will watch
over you. Understanding will keep
you, 002:012 to deliver you from**

**the way of evil, from the men who
speak perverse things; 002:013 who
forsake the paths of uprightness, to
walk in the ways of darkness;
002:014 who rejoice to do evil, and
delight in the perverseness of evil;
002:015 who are crooked in their
ways, and wayward in their paths:
002:016 To deliver you from the
strange woman, even from the
foreigner who flatters with her
words; 002:017 who forsakes the
friend of her youth, and forgets the
covenant of her God: 002:018 for
her house leads down to death, her
paths to the dead. 002:019 None
who go to her return again, neither
do they attain to the paths of life:**

002:020 that you may walk in the way of good men, and keep the paths of the righteous. 002:021 For the upright will dwell in the land. The perfect will remain in it.

002:022 But the wicked will be cut off from the land. The treacherous will be rooted out of it. 003:001 My son, don't forget my teaching; but let your heart keep my commandments: 003:002 for length of days, and years of life, and peace, will they add to you. 003:003 Don't let kindness and truth forsake you. Bind them around your neck. Write them on the tablet of your heart. 003:004 So you will find favor, and good understanding

in the sight of God and man.

003:005 Trust in Yahweh with all your heart, and don't lean on your own understanding. 003:006 In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make your paths straight.

003:007 Don't be wise in your own eyes. Fear Yahweh, and depart from evil. 003:008 It will be health to your body, and nourishment to your bones. 003:009 Honor Yahweh with your substance, with the first fruits of all your increase: 003:010 so your barns will be filled with plenty, and your vats will overflow with new wine. 003:011 My son, don't despise Yahweh's discipline, neither be weary of his reproof:

003:012 for whom Yahweh loves, he reproves; even as a father reproves the son in whom he delights.

003:013 Happy is the man who finds wisdom, the man who gets understanding. 003:014 For her good profit is better than getting silver, and her return is better than fine gold. 003:015 She is more precious than rubies. None of the things you can desire are to be compared to her. 003:016 Length of days is in her right hand. In her left hand are riches and honor. 003:017 Her ways are ways of pleasantness. All her paths are peace. 003:018 She is a tree of life to those who lay hold of her. Happy is everyone who

**retains her. 003:019 By wisdom
Yahweh founded the earth. By
understanding, he established the
heavens. 003:020 By his knowledge,
the depths were broken up, and the
skies drop down the dew. 003:021
My son, let them not depart from
your eyes. Keep sound wisdom and
discretion: 003:022 so they will be
life to your soul, and grace for your
neck. 003:023 Then you shall walk
in your way securely. Your foot
won't stumble. 003:024 When you
lie down, you will not be afraid.
Yes, you will lie down, and your
sleep will be sweet. 003:025 Don't
be afraid of sudden fear, neither of
the desolation of the wicked, when**

it comes: 003:026 for Yahweh will be your confidence, and will keep your foot from being taken.

003:027 Don't withhold good from those to whom it is due, when it is in the power of your hand to do it.

003:028 Don't say to your neighbor, "Go, and come again; tomorrow I will give it to you," when you have it by you. 003:029 Don't devise evil against your neighbor, seeing he dwells securely by you. 003:030

Don't strive with a man without cause, if he has done you no harm.

003:031 Don't envy the man of violence. Choose none of his ways.

003:032 For the perverse is an abomination to Yahweh, but his

friendship is with the upright.

003:033 Yahweh's curse is in the house of the wicked, but he blesses the habitation of the righteous.

003:034 Surely he mocks the mockers, but he gives grace to the humble. 003:035 The wise will inherit glory, but shame will be the promotion of fools. 004:001 Listen,

sons, to a father's instruction. Pay attention and know understanding; 004:002 for I give you sound learning. Don't forsake my law.

004:003 For I was a son to my father, tender and an only child in the sight of my mother. 004:004 He taught me, and said to me: "Let your heart retain my words. Keep

my commandments, and live.

004:005 Get wisdom. Get understanding. Don't forget, neither swerve from the words of my mouth. 004:006 Don't forsake her, and she will preserve you. Love her, and she will keep you. 004:007 Wisdom is supreme. Get wisdom.

Yes, though it costs all your possessions, get understanding.

004:008 Esteem her, and she will exalt you. She will bring you to honor, when you embrace her.

004:009 She will give to your head a garland of grace. She will deliver a crown of splendor to you."

004:010 Listen, my son, and receive my sayings. The years of your life

**will be many. 004:011 I have taught
you in the way of wisdom. I have
led you in straight paths. 004:012
When you go, your steps will not be
hampered. When you run, you will
not stumble. 004:013 Take firm
hold of instruction. Don't let her go.
Keep her, for she is your life.
004:014 Don't enter into the path of
the wicked. Don't walk in the way
of evil men. 004:015 Avoid it, and
don't pass by it. Turn from it, and
pass on. 004:016 For they don't
sleep, unless they do evil. Their
sleep is taken away, unless they
make someone fall. 004:017 For
they eat the bread of wickedness,
and drink the wine of violence.**

004:018 But the path of the righteous is like the dawning light, that shines more and more until the perfect day. 004:019 The way of the wicked is like darkness. They don't know what they stumble over.

004:020 My son, attend to my words. Turn your ear to my sayings. 004:021 Let them not depart from your eyes. Keep them in the midst of your heart. 004:022 For they are life to those who find them, and health to their whole body. 004:023 Keep your heart with all diligence, for out of it is the wellspring of life. 004:024 Put away from yourself a perverse mouth. Put corrupt lips far from you.

004:025 Let your eyes look straight ahead. Fix your gaze directly before you. 004:026 Make the path of your feet level. Let all of your ways be established. 004:027 Don't turn to the right hand nor to the left. Remove your foot from evil. 005:001 My son, pay attention to my wisdom. Turn your ear to my understanding: 005:002 that you may maintain discretion, that your lips may preserve knowledge. 005:003 For the lips of an adulteress drip honey. Her mouth is smoother than oil, 005:004 But in the end she is as bitter as wormwood, and as sharp as a two-edged sword. 005:005 Her feet go

**down to death. Her steps lead
straight to Sheol. 005:006 She gives
no thought to the way of life. Her
ways are crooked, and she doesn't
know it. 005:007 Now therefore, my
sons, listen to me. Don't depart
from the words of my mouth.
005:008 Remove your way far from
her. Don't come near the door of
her house, 005:009 lest you give
your honor to others, and your
years to the cruel one; 005:010 lest
strangers feast on your wealth, and
your labors enrich another man's
house. 005:011 You will groan at
your latter end, when your flesh
and your body are consumed,
005:012 and say, "How I have**

**hated instruction, and my heart
despised reproof; 005:013 neither
have I obeyed the voice of my
teachers, nor turned my ear to
those who instructed me! 005:014 I
have come to the brink of utter
ruin, in the midst of the gathered
assembly." 005:015 Drink water
out of your own cistern, running
water out of your own well. 005:016
Should your springs overflow in the
streets, streams of water in the
public squares? 005:017 Let them
be for yourself alone, not for
strangers with you. 005:018 Let
your spring be blessed. Rejoice in
the wife of your youth. 005:019 A
loving doe and a graceful deer—let**

**her breasts satisfy you at all times.
Be captivated always with her love.
005:020 For why should you, my
son, be captivated with an
adulteress? Why embrace the
bosom of another? 005:021 For the
ways of man are before the eyes of
Yahweh. He examines all his paths.
005:022 The evil deeds of the
wicked ensnare him. The cords of
his sin hold him firmly. 005:023 He
will die for lack of instruction. In
the greatness of his folly, he will go
astray. 006:001 My son, if you have
become collateral for your
neighbor, if you have struck your
hands in pledge for a stranger;
006:002 You are trapped by the**

**words of your mouth. You are
ensnared with the words of your
mouth. 006:003 Do this now, my
son, and deliver yourself, seeing
you have come into the hand of
your neighbor. Go, humble
yourself. Press your plea with your
neighbor. 006:004 Give no sleep to
your eyes, nor slumber to your
eyelids. 006:005 Free yourself, like
a gazelle from the hand of the
hunter, like a bird from the snare of
the fowler. 006:006 Go to the ant,
you sluggard. Consider her ways,
and be wise; 006:007 which having
no chief, overseer, or ruler, 006:008
provides her bread in the summer,
and gathers her food in the harvest.**

006:009 How long will you sleep, sluggard? When will you arise out of your sleep? 006:010 A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep: 006:011 so your poverty will come as a robber, and your scarcity as an armed man.

006:012 A worthless person, a man of iniquity, is he who walks with a perverse mouth; 006:013 who winks with his eyes, who signals with his feet, who motions with his fingers; 006:014 in whose heart is perverseness, who devises evil continually, who always sows discord. 006:015 Therefore his calamity will come suddenly. He will be broken suddenly, and that

without remedy. 006:016 There are six things which Yahweh hates; yes, seven which are an abomination to him: 006:017 haughty eyes, a lying tongue, hands that shed innocent blood; 006:018 a heart that devises wicked schemes, feet that are swift in running to mischief, 006:019 a false witness who utters lies, and he who sows discord among brothers. 006:020 My son, keep your father's commandment, and don't forsake your mother's teaching. 006:021 Bind them continually on your heart. Tie them around your neck. 006:022 When you walk, it will lead you. When you sleep, it will watch over you. When you awake, it will

talk with you. 006:023 For the commandment is a lamp, and the law is light. Reproofs of instruction are the way of life, 006:024 to keep you from the immoral woman, from the flattery of the wayward wife's tongue. 006:025 Don't lust after her beauty in your heart, neither let her captivate you with her eyelids. 006:026 For a prostitute reduces you to a piece of bread. The adulteress hunts for your precious life. 006:027 Can a man scoop fire into his lap, and his clothes not be burned? 006:028 Or can one walk on hot coals, and his feet not be scorched? 006:029 So is he who goes in to his neighbor's

wife. Whoever touches her will not be unpunished. 006:030 Men don't despise a thief, if he steals to satisfy himself when he is hungry: 006:031 but if he is found, he shall restore seven times. He shall give all the wealth of his house. 006:032 He who commits adultery with a woman is void of understanding. He who does it destroys his own soul. 006:033 He will get wounds and dishonor. His reproach will not be wiped away. 006:034 For jealousy arouses the fury of the husband. He won't spare in the day of vengeance. 006:035 He won't regard any ransom, neither will he rest content, though you give many

gifts. 007:001 My son, keep my words. Lay up my commandments within you. 007:002 Keep my commandments and live! Guard my teaching as the apple of your eye. 007:003 Bind them on your fingers. Write them on the tablet of your heart. 007:004 Tell wisdom, "You are my sister." Call understanding your relative, 007:005 that they may keep you from the strange woman, from the foreigner who flatters with her words. 007:006 For at the window of my house, I looked out through my lattice. 007:007 I saw among the simple ones. I discerned among the youths a young man void of

**understanding, 007:008 passing
through the street near her corner,
he went the way to her house,
007:009 in the twilight, in the
evening of the day, in the middle of
the night and in the darkness.
007:010 Behold, there a woman met
him with the attire of a prostitute,
and with crafty intent. 007:011 She
is loud and defiant. Her feet don't
stay in her house. 007:012 Now she
is in the streets, now in the squares,
and lurking at every corner.
007:013 So she caught him, and
kissed him. With an impudent face
she said to him: 007:014 "Sacrifices
of peace offerings are with me. This
day I have paid my vows. 007:015**

**Therefore I came out to meet you,
to diligently seek your face, and I
have found you. 007:016 I have
spread my couch with carpets of
tapestry, with striped cloths of the
yarn of Egypt. 007:017 I have
perfumed my bed with myrrh,
aloes, and cinnamon. 007:018
Come, let's take our fill of loving
until the morning. Let's solace
ourselves with loving. 007:019 For
my husband isn't at home. He has
gone on a long journey. 007:020 He
has taken a bag of money with him.
He will come home at the full
moon." 007:021 With persuasive
words, she led him astray. With the
flattering of her lips, she seduced**

him. 007:022 He followed her immediately, as an ox goes to the slaughter, as a fool stepping into a noose. 007:023 Until an arrow strikes through his liver, as a bird hurries to the snare, and doesn't know that it will cost his life.

007:024 Now therefore, sons, listen to me. Pay attention to the words of my mouth. 007:025 Don't let your heart turn to her ways. Don't go astray in her paths, 007:026 for she has thrown down many wounded.

Yes, all her slain are a mighty army. 007:027 Her house is the way to Sheol, going down to the chambers of death. 008:001 Doesn't wisdom cry out? Doesn't

understanding raise her voice?

**008:002 On the top of high places
by the way, where the paths meet,
she stands. 008:003 Beside the**

**gates, at the entry of the city, at the
entry doors, she cries aloud:**

**008:004 "To you men, I call! I send
my voice to the sons of mankind.**

**008:005 You simple, understand
prudence. You fools, be of an
understanding heart. 008:006 Hear,
for I will speak excellent things.**

**The opening of my lips is for right
things. 008:007 For my mouth**

**speaks truth. Wickedness is an
abomination to my lips. 008:008 All
the words of my mouth are in
righteousness. There is nothing**

crooked or perverse in them.

**008:009 They are all plain to him
who understands, right to those
who find knowledge. 008:010**

**Receive my instruction rather than
silver; knowledge rather than**

**choice gold. 008:011 For wisdom is
better than rubies. All the things**

that may be desired can't be

**compared to it. 008:012 "I, wisdom,
have made prudence my dwelling.**

Find out knowledge and discretion.

008:013 The fear of Yahweh is to

hate evil. I hate pride, arrogance,

the evil way, and the perverse

mouth. 008:014 Counsel and sound

knowledge are mine. I have

understanding and power. 008:015

**By me kings reign, and princes
decree justice. 008:016 By me
princes rule; nobles, and all the
righteous rulers of the earth.
008:017 I love those who love me.
Those who seek me diligently will
find me. 008:018 With me are
riches, honor, enduring wealth, and
prosperity. 008:019 My fruit is
better than gold, yes, than fine
gold; my yield than choice silver.
008:020 I walk in the way of
righteousness, in the midst of the
paths of justice; 008:021 That I
may give wealth to those who love
me. I fill their treasuries. 008:022
"Yahweh possessed me in the
beginning of his work, before his**

deeds of old. 008:023 I was set up
from everlasting, from the
beginning, before the earth existed.
008:024 When there were no
depths, I was brought forth, when
there were no springs abounding
with water. 008:025 Before the
mountains were settled in place,
before the hills, I was brought
forth; 008:026 while as yet he had
not made the earth, nor the fields,
nor the beginning of the dust of the
world. 008:027 When he
established the heavens, I was
there; when he set a circle on the
surface of the deep, 008:028 when
he established the clouds above,
when the springs of the deep

**became strong, 008:029 when he
gave to the sea its boundary, that
the waters should not violate his
commandment, when he marked
out the foundations of the earth;
008:030 then I was the craftsman
by his side. I was a delight day by
day, always rejoicing before him,
008:031 Rejoicing in his whole
world. My delight was with the
sons of men. 008:032 "Now
therefore, my sons, listen to me, for
blessed are those who keep my
ways. 008:033 Hear instruction,
and be wise. Don't refuse it.
008:034 Blessed is the man who
hears me, watching daily at my
gates, waiting at my door posts.**

**008:035 For whoever finds me,
finds life, and will obtain favor
from Yahweh. 008:036 But he who
sins against me wrongs his own
soul. All those who hate me love
death." 009:001 Wisdom has built
her house. She has carved out her
seven pillars. 009:002 She has
prepared her meat. She has mixed
her wine. She has also set her table.
009:003 She has sent out her
maidens. She cries from the highest
places of the city: 009:004
"Whoever is simple, let him turn in
here!" As for him who is void of
understanding, she says to him,
009:005 "Come, eat some of my
bread, Drink some of the wine**

which I have mixed! 009:006 Leave your simple ways, and live. Walk in the way of understanding." 009:007 He who corrects a mocker invites insult. He who reproves a wicked man invites abuse. 009:008 Don't reprove a scoffer, lest he hate you. Reprove a wise man, and he will love you. 009:009 Instruct a wise man, and he will be still wiser. Teach a righteous man, and he will increase in learning. 009:010 The fear of Yahweh is the beginning of wisdom. The knowledge of the Holy One is understanding. 009:011 For by me your days will be multiplied. The years of your life will be increased. 009:012 If you are wise,

you are wise for yourself. If you mock, you alone will bear it.

009:013 The foolish woman is loud, Undisciplined, and knows nothing.

009:014 She sits at the door of her house, on a seat in the high places of the city, 009:015 To call to those who pass by, who go straight on their ways, 009:016 "Whoever is simple, let him turn in here." as for him who is void of understanding, she says to him, 009:017 "Stolen water is sweet. Food eaten in secret is pleasant." 009:018 But he doesn't know that the dead are there, that her guests are in the depths of Sheol. 010:001 The proverbs of Solomon. A wise son makes a glad

**father; but a foolish son brings
grief to his mother. 010:002**

**Treasures of wickedness profit
nothing, but righteousness delivers
from death. 010:003 Yahweh will
not allow the soul of the righteous
to go hungry, but he thrusts away
the desire of the wicked. 010:004**

**He becomes poor who works with a
lazy hand, but the hand of the
diligent brings wealth. 010:005 He
who gathers in summer is a wise
son, but he who sleeps during the
harvest is a son who causes shame.**

**010:006 Blessings are on the head
of the righteous, but violence
covers the mouth of the wicked.**

010:007 The memory of the

**righteous is blessed, but the name
of the wicked will rot. 010:008 The
wise in heart accept
commandments, but a chattering
fool will fall. 010:009 He who walks
blamelessly walks surely, but he
who perverts his ways will be found
out. 010:010 One winking with the
eye causes sorrow, but a chattering
fool will fall. 010:011 The mouth of
the righteous is a spring of life, but
violence covers the mouth of the
wicked. 010:012 Hatred stirs up
strife, but love covers all wrongs.
010:013 Wisdom is found on the
lips of him who has discernment,
but a rod is for the back of him
who is void of understanding.**

**010:014 Wise men lay up
knowledge, but the mouth of the
foolish is near ruin. 010:015 The
rich man's wealth is his strong city.
The destruction of the poor is their
poverty. 010:016 The labor of the
righteous leads to life. The increase
of the wicked leads to sin. 010:017
He is in the way of life who heeds
correction, but he who forsakes
reproof leads others astray. 010:018
He who hides hatred has lying lips.
He who utters a slander is a fool.
010:019 In the multitude of words
there is no lack of disobedience, but
he who restrains his lips does
wisely. 010:020 The tongue of the
righteous is like choice silver. The**

heart of the wicked is of little worth. 010:021 The lips of the righteous feed many, but the foolish die for lack of understanding.

010:022 Yahweh's blessing brings wealth, and he adds no trouble to

it. 010:023 It is a fool's pleasure to do wickedness, but wisdom is a man of understanding's pleasure.

010:024 What the wicked fear, will overtake them, but the desire of the righteous will be granted. 010:025

When the whirlwind passes, the wicked is no more; but the righteous stand firm forever.

010:026 As vinegar to the teeth, and as smoke to the eyes, so is the sluggard to those who send him.

**010:027 The fear of Yahweh
prolongs days, but the years of the
wicked shall be shortened. 010:028
The prospect of the righteous is joy,
but the hope of the wicked will
perish. 010:029 The way of Yahweh
is a stronghold to the upright, but it
is a destruction to the workers of
iniquity. 010:030 The righteous will
never be removed, but the wicked
will not dwell in the land. 010:031
The mouth of the righteous brings
forth wisdom, but the perverse
tongue will be cut off. 010:032 The
lips of the righteous know what is
acceptable, but the mouth of the
wicked is perverse. 011:001 A false
balance is an abomination to**

Yahweh, but accurate weights are his delight. 011:002 When pride comes, then comes shame, but with humility comes wisdom. 011:003 The integrity of the upright shall guide them, but the perverseness of the treacherous shall destroy them. 011:004 Riches don't profit in the day of wrath, but righteousness delivers from death. 011:005 The righteousness of the blameless will direct his way, but the wicked shall fall by his own wickedness. 011:006 The righteousness of the upright shall deliver them, but the unfaithful will be trapped by evil desires. 011:007 When a wicked man dies, hope perishes, and

expectation of power comes to nothing. 011:008 A righteous person is delivered out of trouble, and the wicked takes his place. 011:009 With his mouth the godless man destroys his neighbor, but the righteous will be delivered through knowledge. 011:010 When it goes well with the righteous, the city rejoices. When the wicked perish, there is shouting. 011:011 By the blessing of the upright, the city is exalted, but it is overthrown by the mouth of the wicked. 011:012 One who despises his neighbor is void of wisdom, but a man of understanding holds his peace. 011:013 One who brings gossip

**betrays a confidence, but one who
is of a trustworthy spirit is one who
keeps a secret. 011:014 Where there
is no wise guidance, the nation falls,
but in the multitude of counselors
there is victory. 011:015 He who is
collateral for a stranger will suffer
for it, but he who refuses pledges of
collateral is secure. 011:016 A
gracious woman obtains honor, but
violent men obtain riches. 011:017
The merciful man does good to his
own soul, but he who is cruel
troubles his own flesh. 011:018
Wicked people earn deceitful
wages, but one who sows
righteousness reaps a sure reward.
011:019 He who is truly righteous**

gets life. He who pursues evil gets death. 011:020 Those who are perverse in heart are an abomination to Yahweh, but those whose ways are blameless are his delight. 011:021 Most certainly, the evil man will not be unpunished, but the seed of the righteous will be delivered. 011:022 Like a gold ring in a pig's snout, is a beautiful woman who lacks discretion. 011:023 The desire of the righteous is only good. The expectation of the wicked is wrath. 011:024 There is one who scatters, and increases yet more. There is one who withholds more than is appropriate, but gains poverty. 011:025 The liberal soul

**shall be made fat. He who waters
shall be watered also himself.**

**011:026 People curse someone who
withholds grain, but blessing will
be on the head of him who sells it.**

**011:027 He who diligently seeks
good seeks favor, but he who
searches after evil, it shall come to
him. 011:028 He who trusts in his
riches will fall, but the righteous
shall flourish as the green leaf.**

**011:029 He who troubles his own
house shall inherit the wind. The
foolish shall be servant to the wise
of heart. 011:030 The fruit of the
righteous is a tree of life. He who is
wise wins souls. 011:031 Behold, the
righteous shall be repaid in the**

earth; how much more the wicked and the sinner! 012:001 Whoever loves correction loves knowledge, but he who hates reproof is stupid. 012:002 A good man shall obtain favor from Yahweh, but he will condemn a man of wicked devices. 012:003 A man shall not be established by wickedness, but the root of the righteous shall not be moved. 012:004 A worthy woman is the crown of her husband, but a disgraceful wife is as rottenness in his bones. 012:005 The thoughts of the righteous are just, but the advice of the wicked is deceitful. 012:006 The words of the wicked are about lying in wait for blood,

**but the speech of the upright
rescues them. 012:007 The wicked
are overthrown, and are no more,
but the house of the righteous shall
stand. 012:008 A man shall be
commended according to his
wisdom, but he who has a warped
mind shall be despised. 012:009
Better is he who is lightly esteemed,
and has a servant, than he who
honors himself, and lacks bread.
012:010 A righteous man regards
the life of his animal, but the tender
mercies of the wicked are cruel.
012:011 He who tills his land shall
have plenty of bread, but he who
chases fantasies is void of
understanding. 012:012 The wicked**

desires the plunder of evil men, but the root of the righteous flourishes. 012:013 An evil man is trapped by sinfulness of lips, but the righteous shall come out of trouble. 012:014 A man shall be satisfied with good by the fruit of his mouth. The work of a man's hands shall be rewarded to him. 012:015 The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but he who is wise listens to counsel. 012:016 A fool shows his annoyance the same day, but one who overlooks an insult is prudent. 012:017 He who is truthful testifies honestly, but a false witness lies. 012:018 There is one who speaks rashly like the piercing of a sword, but the tongue

of the wise heals. 012:019 Truth's lips will be established forever, but a lying tongue is only momentary. 012:020 Deceit is in the heart of those who plot evil, but joy comes to the promoters of peace. 012:021 No mischief shall happen to the righteous, but the wicked shall be filled with evil. 012:022 Lying lips are an abomination to Yahweh, but those who do the truth are his delight. 012:023 A prudent man keeps his knowledge, but the hearts of fools proclaim foolishness. 012:024 The hands of the diligent ones shall rule, but laziness ends in slave labor. 012:025 Anxiety in a man's heart weighs it down, but a

kind word makes it glad. 012:026 A
righteous person is cautious in
friendship, but the way of the
wicked leads them astray. 012:027
The slothful man doesn't roast his
game, but the possessions of
diligent men are prized. 012:028 In
the way of righteousness is life; in
its path there is no death. 013:001 A
wise son listens to his father's
instruction, but a scoffer doesn't
listen to rebuke. 013:002 By the
fruit of his lips, a man enjoys good
things; but the unfaithful crave
violence. 013:003 He who guards
his mouth guards his soul. One who
opens wide his lips comes to ruin.
013:004 The soul of the sluggard

**desires, and has nothing, but the
desire of the diligent shall be fully
satisfied. 013:005 A righteous man
hates lies, but a wicked man brings
shame and disgrace. 013:006**

**Righteousness guards the way of
integrity, but wickedness
overthrows the sinner. 013:007**

**There are some who pretend to be
rich, yet have nothing. There are
some who pretend to be poor, yet
have great wealth. 013:008 The
ransom of a man's life is his riches,
but the poor hear no threats.**

**013:009 The light of the righteous
shines brightly, but the lamp of the
wicked is snuffed out. 013:010**

Pride only breeds quarrels, but

**with ones who take advice is
wisdom. 013:011 Wealth gained
dishonestly dwindles away, but he
who gathers by hand makes it
grow. 013:012 Hope deferred
makes the heart sick, but when
longing is fulfilled, it is a tree of life.
013:013 Whoever despises
instruction will pay for it, but he
who respects a command will be
rewarded. 013:014 The teaching of
the wise is a spring of life, to turn
from the snares of death. 013:015
Good understanding wins favor;
but the way of the unfaithful is
hard. 013:016 Every prudent man
acts from knowledge, but a fool
exposes folly. 013:017 A wicked**

messenger falls into trouble, but a trustworthy envoy gains healing. 013:018 Poverty and shame come to him who refuses discipline, but he who heeds correction shall be honored. 013:019 Longing fulfilled is sweet to the soul, but fools detest turning from evil. 013:020 One who walks with wise men grows wise, but a companion of fools suffers harm. 013:021 Misfortune pursues sinners, but prosperity rewards the righteous. 013:022 A good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children, but the wealth of the sinner is stored for the righteous. 013:023 An abundance of food is in poor people's fields,

but injustice sweeps it away.

013:024 One who spares the rod hates his son, but one who loves him is careful to discipline him.

013:025 The righteous one eats to the satisfying of his soul, but the belly of the wicked goes hungry.

014:001 Every wise woman builds her house, but the foolish one tears it down with her own hands.

014:002 He who walks in his uprightness fears Yahweh, but he who is perverse in his ways despises him. 014:003 The fool's talk brings a rod to his back, but the lips of the wise protect them. 014:004 Where no oxen are, the crib is clean, but much increase is by the strength of

the ox. 014:005 A truthful witness will not lie, but a false witness pours out lies. 014:006 A scoffer seeks wisdom, and doesn't find it, but knowledge comes easily to a discerning person. 014:007 Stay away from a foolish man, for you won't find knowledge on his lips. 014:008 The wisdom of the prudent is to think about his way, but the folly of fools is deceit. 014:009 Fools mock at making atonement for sins, but among the upright there is good will. 014:010 The heart knows its own bitterness and joy; he will not share these with a stranger. 014:011 The house of the wicked will be overthrown, but the tent of

the upright will flourish. 014:012

There is a way which seems right to a man, but in the end it leads to

death. 014:013 Even in laughter the heart may be sorrowful, and mirth

may end in heaviness. 014:014 The unfaithful will be repaid for his

own ways; likewise a good man will be rewarded for his ways. 014:015

A simple man believes everything, but the prudent man carefully

considers his ways. 014:016 A wise man fears, and shuns evil, but the fool is hotheaded and reckless.

014:017 He who is quick to become angry will commit folly, and a

crafty man is hated. 014:018 The simple inherit folly, but the prudent

are crowned with knowledge.

014:019 The evil bow down before the good, and the wicked at the gates of the righteous. 014:020 The poor person is shunned even by his own neighbor, but the rich person has many friends. 014:021 He who despises his neighbor sins, but blessed is he who has pity on the poor. 014:022 Don't they go astray who plot evil? But love and faithfulness belong to those who plan good. 014:023 In all hard work there is profit, but the talk of the lips leads only to poverty.

014:024 The crown of the wise is their riches, but the folly of fools crowns them with folly. 014:025 A

truthful witness saves souls, but a false witness is deceitful. 014:026 In the fear of Yahweh is a secure fortress, and he will be a refuge for his children. 014:027 The fear of Yahweh is a fountain of life, turning people from the snares of death. 014:028 In the multitude of people is the king's glory, but in the lack of people is the destruction of the prince. 014:029 He who is slow to anger has great understanding, but he who has a quick temper displays folly. 014:030 The life of the body is a heart at peace, but envy rots the bones. 014:031 He who oppresses the poor shows contempt for his Maker, but he who

is kind to the needy honors him. 014:032 The wicked is brought down in his calamity, but in death, the righteous has a refuge. 014:033 Wisdom rests in the heart of one who has understanding, and is even made known in the inward part of fools. 014:034 Righteousness exalts a nation, but sin is a disgrace to any people. 014:035 The king's favor is toward a servant who deals wisely, but his wrath is toward one who causes shame. 015:001 A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger. 015:002 The tongue of the wise commends knowledge, but the mouth of fools gush out folly. 015:003 Yahweh's

**eyes are everywhere, keeping watch
on the evil and the good. 015:004 A
gentle tongue is a tree of life, but
deceit in it crushes the spirit.**

**015:005 A fool despises his father's
correction, but he who heeds
reproof shows prudence. 015:006**

**In the house of the righteous is
much treasure, but the income of
the wicked brings trouble. 015:007**

**The lips of the wise spread
knowledge; not so with the heart of
fools. 015:008 The sacrifice made**

**by the wicked is an abomination to
Yahweh, but the prayer of the
upright is his delight. 015:009 The**

**way of the wicked is an
abomination to Yahweh, but he**

**loves him who follows after
righteousness. 015:010 There is
stern discipline for one who
forsakes the way: whoever hates
reproof shall die. 015:011 Sheol and
Abaddon are before Yahweh—how
much more then the hearts of the
children of men! 015:012 A scoffer
doesn't love to be reproved; he will
not go to the wise. 015:013 A glad
heart makes a cheerful face; but an
aching heart breaks the spirit.
015:014 The heart of one who has
understanding seeks knowledge,
but the mouths of fools feed on
folly. 015:015 All the days of the
afflicted are wretched, but one who
has a cheerful heart enjoys a**

continual feast. 015:016 Better is little, with the fear of Yahweh, than great treasure with trouble.

015:017 Better is a dinner of herbs, where love is, than a fattened calf

with hatred. 015:018 A wrathful man stirs up contention, but one who is slow to anger appeases

strife. 015:019 The way of the sluggard is like a thorn patch, but the path of the upright is a

highway. 015:020 A wise son makes a father glad, but a foolish man

despises his mother. 015:021 Folly is joy to one who is void of wisdom, but a man of understanding keeps

his way straight. 015:022 Where there is no counsel, plans fail; but

**in a multitude of counselors they
are established. 015:023 Joy comes
to a man with the reply of his
mouth. How good is a word at the
right time! 015:024 The path of life
leads upward for the wise, to keep
him from going downward to
Sheol. 015:025 Yahweh will uproot
the house of the proud, but he will
keep the widow's borders intact.
015:026 Yahweh detests the
thoughts of the wicked, but the
thoughts of the pure are pleasing.
015:027 He who is greedy for gain
troubles his own house, but he who
hates bribes will live. 015:028 The
heart of the righteous weighs
answers, but the mouth of the**

wicked gushes out evil. 015:029
Yahweh is far from the wicked, but
he hears the prayer of the
righteous. 015:030 The light of the
eyes rejoices the heart. Good news
gives health to the bones. 015:031
The ear that listens to reproof lives,
and will be at home among the
wise. 015:032 He who refuses
correction despises his own soul,
but he who listens to reproof gets
understanding. 015:033 The fear of
Yahweh teaches wisdom. Before
honor is humility. 016:001 The
plans of the heart belong to man,
but the answer of the tongue is
from Yahweh. 016:002 All the ways
of a man are clean in his own eyes;

but Yahweh weighs the motives.

016:003 Commit your deeds to Yahweh, and your plans shall succeed. 016:004 Yahweh has made everything for its own end—yes, even the wicked for the day of evil.

016:005 Everyone who is proud in heart is an abomination to Yahweh: they shall certainly not be unpunished. 016:006 By mercy and truth iniquity is atoned for. By the fear of Yahweh men depart from evil. 016:007 When a man's ways please Yahweh, he makes even his enemies to be at peace with him.

016:008 Better is a little with righteousness, than great revenues with injustice. 016:009 A man's

heart plans his course, but Yahweh directs his steps. 016:010 Inspired judgments are on the lips of the king. He shall not betray his mouth. 016:011 Honest balances and scales are Yahweh's; all the weights in the bag are his work. 016:012 It is an abomination for kings to do wrong, for the throne is established by righteousness. 016:013 Righteous lips are the delight of kings. They value one who speaks the truth. 016:014 The king's wrath is a messenger of death, but a wise man will pacify it. 016:015 In the light of the king's face is life. His favor is like a cloud of the spring rain. 016:016 How

**much better it is to get wisdom
than gold! Yes, to get
understanding is to be chosen
rather than silver. 016:017 The
highway of the upright is to depart
from evil. He who keeps his way
preserves his soul. 016:018 Pride
goes before destruction, and a
haughty spirit before a fall. 016:019
It is better to be of a lowly spirit
with the poor, than to divide the
plunder with the proud. 016:020 He
who heeds the Word finds
prosperity. Whoever trusts in
Yahweh is blessed. 016:021 The
wise in heart shall be called
prudent. Pleasantness of the lips
promotes instruction. 016:022**

**Understanding is a fountain of life
to one who has it, but the
punishment of fools is their folly.**

**016:023 The heart of the wise
instructs his mouth, and adds
learning to his lips. 016:024**

**Pleasant words are a honeycomb,
sweet to the soul, and health to the
bones. 016:025 There is a way
which seems right to a man, but in
the end it leads to death. 016:026**

**The appetite of the laboring man
labors for him; for his mouth urges
him on. 016:027 A worthless man
devises mischief. His speech is like
a scorching fire. 016:028 A perverse
man stirs up strife. A whisperer
separates close friends. 016:029 A**

man of violence entices his neighbor, and leads him in a way that is not good. 016:030 One who winks his eyes to plot perversities, one who compresses his lips, is bent on evil. 016:031 Gray hair is a crown of glory. It is attained by a life of righteousness. 016:032 One who is slow to anger is better than the mighty; one who rules his spirit, than he who takes a city. 016:033 The lot is cast into the lap, but its every decision is from Yahweh. 017:001 Better is a dry morsel with quietness, than a house full of feasting with strife. 017:002 A servant who deals wisely will rule over a son who causes shame, and

**shall have a part in the inheritance
among the brothers. 017:003 The
refining pot is for silver, and the
furnace for gold, but Yahweh tests
the hearts. 017:004 An evil-doer
heeds wicked lips. A liar gives ear
to a mischievous tongue. 017:005
Whoever mocks the poor
reproaches his Maker. He who is
glad at calamity shall not be
unpunished. 017:006 Children's
children are the crown of old men;
the glory of children are their
parents. 017:007 Arrogant speech
isn't fitting for a fool, much less do
lying lips fit a prince. 017:008 A
bribe is a precious stone in the eyes
of him who gives it; wherever he**

turns, he prospers. 017:009 He who covers an offense promotes love; but he who repeats a matter separates best friends. 017:010 A rebuke enters deeper into one who has understanding than a hundred lashes into a fool. 017:011 An evil man seeks only rebellion; therefore a cruel messenger shall be sent against him. 017:012 Let a bear robbed of her cubs meet a man, rather than a fool in his folly. 017:013 Whoever rewards evil for good, evil shall not depart from his house. 017:014 The beginning of strife is like breaching a dam, therefore stop contention before quarreling breaks out. 017:015 He

**who justifies the wicked, and he
who condemns the righteous, both
of them alike are an abomination to
Yahweh. 017:016 Why is there
money in the hand of a fool to buy
wisdom, seeing he has no
understanding? 017:017 A friend
loves at all times; and a brother is
born for adversity. 017:018 A man
void of understanding strikes
hands, and becomes collateral in
the presence of his neighbor.
017:019 He who loves disobedience
loves strife. One who builds a high
gate seeks destruction. 017:020 One
who has a perverse heart doesn't
find prosperity, and one who has a
deceitful tongue falls into trouble.**

017:021 He who becomes the father of a fool grieves. The father of a fool has no joy. 017:022 A cheerful heart makes good medicine, but a crushed spirit dries up the bones. 017:023 A wicked man receives a bribe in secret, to pervert the ways of justice. 017:024 Wisdom is before the face of one who has understanding, but the eyes of a fool wander to the ends of the earth. 017:025 A foolish son brings grief to his father, and bitterness to her who bore him. 017:026 Also to punish the righteous is not good, nor to flog officials for their integrity. 017:027 He who spares his words has knowledge. He who is

**even tempered is a man of
understanding. 017:028 Even a
fool, when he keeps silent, is
counted wise. When he shuts his
lips, he is thought to be discerning.
018:001 An unfriendly man
pursues selfishness, and defies all
sound judgment. 018:002 A fool has
no delight in understanding, but
only in revealing his own opinion.
018:003 When wickedness comes,
contempt also comes, and with
shame comes disgrace. 018:004 The
words of a man's mouth are like
deep waters. The fountain of
wisdom is like a flowing brook.
018:005 To be partial to the faces of
the wicked is not good, nor to**

deprive the innocent of justice.

018:006 A fool's lips come into

strife, and his mouth invites

beatings. 018:007 A fool's mouth is

his destruction, and his lips are a

snare to his soul. 018:008 The

words of a gossip are like dainty

morsels: they go down into a

person's innermost parts. 018:009

One who is slack in his work is

brother to him who is a master of

destruction. 018:010 The name of

Yahweh is a strong tower: the

righteous run to him, and are safe.

018:011 The rich man's wealth is

his strong city, like an unscalable

wall in his own imagination.

018:012 Before destruction the

**heart of man is proud, but before
honor is humility. 018:013 He who
gives answer before he hears, that
is folly and shame to him. 018:014
A man's spirit will sustain him in
sickness, but a crushed spirit, who
can bear? 018:015 The heart of the
discerning gets knowledge. The ear
of the wise seeks knowledge.
018:016 A man's gift makes room
for him, and brings him before
great men. 018:017 He who pleads
his cause first seems right; until
another comes and questions him.
018:018 The lot settles disputes,
and keeps strong ones apart.
018:019 A brother offended is more
difficult than a fortified city; and**

disputes are like the bars of a castle. 018:020 A man's stomach is filled with the fruit of his mouth. With the harvest of his lips he is satisfied. 018:021 Death and life are in the power of the tongue; those who love it will eat its fruit. 018:022 Whoever finds a wife finds a good thing, and obtains favor of Yahweh. 018:023 The poor plead for mercy, but the rich answer harshly. 018:024 A man of many companions may be ruined, but there is a friend who sticks closer than a brother. 019:001 Better is the poor who walks in his integrity than he who is perverse in his lips and is a fool. 019:002 It isn't good

**to have zeal without knowledge;
nor being hasty with one's feet and
missing the way. 019:003 The
foolishness of man subverts his
way; his heart rages against
Yahweh. 019:004 Wealth adds
many friends, but the poor is
separated from his friend. 019:005
A false witness shall not be
unpunished. He who pours out lies
shall not go free. 019:006 Many will
entreat the favor of a ruler, and
everyone is a friend to a man who
gives gifts. 019:007 All the relatives
of the poor shun him: how much
more do his friends avoid him! He
pursues them with pleas, but they
are gone. 019:008 He who gets**

wisdom loves his own soul. He who keeps understanding shall find good. 019:009 A false witness shall not be unpunished. He who utters lies shall perish. 019:010 Delicate living is not appropriate for a fool, much less for a servant to have rule over princes. 019:011 The discretion of a man makes him slow to anger. It is his glory to overlook an offense. 019:012 The king's wrath is like the roaring of a lion, but his favor is like dew on the grass. 019:013 A foolish son is the calamity of his father. A wife's quarrels are a continual dripping. 019:014 House and riches are an inheritance from fathers, but a

prudent wife is from Yahweh.

019:015 Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep. The idle soul shall suffer hunger. 019:016 He who keeps the commandment keeps his soul, but he who is contemptuous in his ways shall die. 019:017 He who has pity on the poor lends to Yahweh; he will reward him.

019:018 Discipline your son, for there is hope; don't be a willing party to his death. 019:019 A hot-tempered man must pay the penalty, for if you rescue him, you must do it again. 019:020 Listen to counsel and receive instruction, that you may be wise in your latter end. 019:021 There are many plans

in a man's heart, but Yahweh's counsel will prevail. 019:022 That which makes a man to be desired is his kindness. A poor man is better than a liar. 019:023 The fear of Yahweh leads to life, then contentment; he rests and will not be touched by trouble. 019:024 The sluggard buries his hand in the dish; he will not so much as bring it to his mouth again. 019:025 Flog a scoffer, and the simple will learn prudence; rebuke one who has understanding, and he will gain knowledge. 019:026 He who robs his father and drives away his mother, is a son who causes shame and brings reproach. 019:027 If

**you stop listening to instruction,
my son, you will stray from the
words of knowledge. 019:028 A
corrupt witness mocks justice, and
the mouth of the wicked gulps
down iniquity. 019:029 Penalties
are prepared for scoffers, and
beatings for the backs of fools.
020:001 Wine is a mocker, and beer
is a brawler. Whoever is led astray
by them is not wise. 020:002 The
terror of a king is like the roaring
of a lion. He who provokes him to
anger forfeits his own life. 020:003
It is an honor for a man to keep
aloof from strife; but every fool will
be quarreling. 020:004 The
 sluggard will not plow by reason of**

**the winter; therefore he shall beg in
harvest, and have nothing. 020:005
Counsel in the heart of man is like
deep water; but a man of
understanding will draw it out.**

**020:006 Many men claim to be men
of unfailing love, but who can find
a faithful man? 020:007 A righteous
man walks in integrity. Blessed are
his children after him. 020:008 A
king who sits on the throne of
judgment scatters away all evil
with his eyes. 020:009 Who can say,
"I have made my heart pure. I am
clean and without sin?" 020:010
Differing weights and differing
measures, both of them alike are an
abomination to Yahweh. 020:011**

Even a child makes himself known by his doings, whether his work is pure, and whether it is right.

020:012 The hearing ear, and the seeing eye, Yahweh has made even both of them. 020:013 Don't love sleep, lest you come to poverty.

Open your eyes, and you shall be satisfied with bread. 020:014 "It's no good, it's no good," says the buyer; but when he is gone his way, then he boasts. 020:015 There is gold and abundance of rubies; but the lips of knowledge are a rare jewel. 020:016 Take the garment of one who puts up collateral for a stranger; and hold him in pledge for a wayward woman. 020:017

**Fraudulent food is sweet to a man,
but afterwards his mouth is filled
with gravel. 020:018 Plans are
established by advice; by wise
guidance you wage war! 020:019
He who goes about as a tale-bearer
reveals secrets; therefore don't
keep company with him who opens
wide his lips. 020:020 Whoever
curses his father or his mother, his
lamp shall be put out in blackness
of darkness. 020:021 An
inheritance quickly gained at the
beginning, won't be blessed in the
end. 020:022 Don't say, "I will pay
back evil." Wait for Yahweh, and
he will save you. 020:023 Yahweh
detests differing weights, and**

**dishonest scales are not pleasing.
020:024 A man's steps are from
Yahweh; how then can man
understand his way? 020:025 It is a
snare to a man to make a rash
dedication, then later to consider
his vows. 020:026 A wise king
winnows out the wicked, and drives
the threshing wheel over them.
020:027 The spirit of man is
Yahweh's lamp, searching all his
innermost parts. 020:028 Love and
faithfulness keep the king safe. His
throne is sustained by love. 020:029
The glory of young men is their
strength. The splendor of old men
is their gray hair. 020:030
Wounding blows cleanse away evil,**

and beatings purge the innermost parts. 021:001 The king's heart is in Yahweh's hand like the watercourses. He turns it wherever he desires. 021:002 Every way of a man is right in his own eyes, but Yahweh weighs the hearts. 021:003 To do righteousness and justice is more acceptable to Yahweh than sacrifice. 021:004 A high look, and a proud heart, the lamp of the wicked, is sin. 021:005 The plans of the diligent surely lead to profit; and everyone who is hasty surely rushes to poverty. 021:006 Getting treasures by a lying tongue is a fleeting vapor for those who seek death. 021:007 The violence of the

wicked will drive them away,
because they refuse to do what is
right. 021:008 The way of the guilty
is devious, but the conduct of the
innocent is upright. 021:009 It is
better to dwell in the corner of the
housetop, than to share a house
with a contentious woman. 021:010
The soul of the wicked desires evil;
his neighbor finds no mercy in his
eyes. 021:011 When the mocker is
punished, the simple gains wisdom.
When the wise is instructed, he
receives knowledge. 021:012 The
Righteous One considers the house
of the wicked, and brings the
wicked to ruin. 021:013 Whoever
stops his ears at the cry of the poor,

he will also cry out, but shall not be heard. 021:014 A gift in secret pacifies anger; and a bribe in the cloak, strong wrath. 021:015 It is joy to the righteous to do justice; but it is a destruction to the workers of iniquity. 021:016 The man who wanders out of the way of understanding shall rest in the assembly of the dead. 021:017 He who loves pleasure shall be a poor man. He who loves wine and oil shall not be rich. 021:018 The wicked is a ransom for the righteous; the treacherous for the upright. 021:019 It is better to dwell in a desert land, than with a contentious and fretful woman.

021:020 There is precious treasure and oil in the dwelling of the wise; but a foolish man swallows it up.

021:021 He who follows after righteousness and kindness finds life, righteousness, and honor.

021:022 A wise man scales the city of the mighty, and brings down the strength of its confidence. 021:023

Whoever guards his mouth and his tongue keeps his soul from

troubles. 021:024 The proud and haughty man, "scoffer" is his

name; he works in the arrogance of pride. 021:025 The desire of the

sluggard kills him, for his hands refuse to labor. 021:026 There are

those who covet greedily all day

long; but the righteous give and don't withhold. 021:027 The sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination: how much more, when he brings it with a wicked mind! 021:028 A false witness will perish, and a man who listens speaks to eternity. 021:029 A wicked man hardens his face; but as for the upright, he establishes his ways. 021:030 There is no wisdom nor understanding nor counsel against Yahweh. 021:031 The horse is prepared for the day of battle; but victory is with Yahweh. 022:001 A good name is more desirable than great riches, and loving favor is better than silver and gold. 022:002

The rich and the poor have this in common: Yahweh is the maker of them all. 022:003 A prudent man sees danger, and hides himself; but the simple pass on, and suffer for it. 022:004 The result of humility and the fear of Yahweh is wealth, honor, and life. 022:005 Thorns and snares are in the path of the wicked: whoever guards his soul stays from them. 022:006 Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not depart from it. 022:007 The rich rule over the poor. The borrower is servant to the lender. 022:008 He who sows wickedness reaps trouble, and the rod of his fury will be destroyed.

022:009 He who has a generous eye will be blessed; for he shares his food with the poor. 022:010 Drive out the mocker, and strife will go out; yes, quarrels and insults will stop. 022:011 He who loves purity of heart and speaks gracefully is the king's friend. 022:012 The eyes of Yahweh watch over knowledge; but he frustrates the words of the unfaithful. 022:013 The sluggard says, "There is a lion outside! I will be killed in the streets!" 022:014 The mouth of an adulteress is a deep pit: he who is under Yahweh's wrath will fall into it. 022:015 Folly is bound up in the heart of a child: the rod of discipline drives it far

**from him. 022:016 Whoever
oppresses the poor for his own
increase and whoever gives to the
rich, both come to poverty. 022:017
Turn your ear, and listen to the
words of the wise. Apply your heart
to my teaching. 022:018 For it is a
pleasant thing if you keep them
within you, if all of them are ready
on your lips. 022:019 That your
trust may be in Yahweh, I teach
you today, even you. 022:020
Haven't I written to you thirty
excellent things of counsel and
knowledge, 022:021 To teach you
truth, reliable words, to give sound
answers to the ones who sent you?
022:022 Don't exploit the poor,**

**because he is poor; and don't crush
the needy in court; 022:023 for
Yahweh will plead their case, and
plunder the life of those who
plunder them. 022:024 Don't
befriend a hot-tempered man, and
don't associate with one who
harbors anger: 022:025 lest you
learn his ways, and ensnare your
soul. 022:026 Don't you be one of
those who strike hands, of those
who are collateral for debts.
022:027 If you don't have means to
pay, why should he take away your
bed from under you? 022:028 Don't
move the ancient boundary stone,
which your fathers have set up.
022:029 Do you see a man skilled in**

his work? He will serve kings. He won't serve obscure men. 023:001 When you sit to eat with a ruler, consider diligently what is before you; 023:002 put a knife to your throat, if you are a man given to appetite. 023:003 Don't be desirous of his dainties, seeing they are deceitful food. 023:004 Don't weary yourself to be rich. In your wisdom, show restraint. 023:005 Why do you set your eyes on that which is not? For it certainly sprouts wings like an eagle and flies in the sky. 023:006 Don't eat the food of him who has a stingy eye, and don't crave his delicacies: 023:007 for as he thinks about the cost, so he is.

**"Eat and drink!" he says to you,
but his heart is not with you.**

**023:008 The morsel which you have
eaten you shall vomit up, and lose
your good words. 023:009 Don't
speak in the ears of a fool, for he
will despise the wisdom of your
words. 023:010 Don't move the
ancient boundary stone. Don't
encroach on the fields of the
fatherless: 023:011 for their
Defender is strong. He will plead
their case against you. 023:012
Apply your heart to instruction,
and your ears to the words of
knowledge. 023:013 Don't withhold
correction from a child. If you
punish him with the rod, he will not**

die. 023:014 Punish him with the rod, and save his soul from Sheol. 023:015 My son, if your heart is wise, then my heart will be glad, even mine: 023:016 yes, my heart will rejoice, when your lips speak what is right. 023:017 Don't let your heart envy sinners; but rather fear Yahweh all the day long. 023:018 Indeed surely there is a future hope, and your hope will not be cut off. 023:019 Listen, my son, and be wise, and keep your heart on the right path! 023:020 Don't be among ones drinking too much wine, or those who gorge themselves on meat: 023:021 for the drunkard and the glutton shall

**become poor; and drowsiness
clothes them in rags. 023:022**

**Listen to your father who gave you
life, and don't despise your mother
when she is old. 023:023 Buy the
truth, and don't sell it. Get wisdom,
discipline, and understanding.**

**023:024 The father of the righteous
has great joy. Whoever fathers a
wise child delights in him. 023:025**

**Let your father and your mother be
glad! Let her who bore you rejoice!**

**023:026 My son, give me your
heart; and let your eyes keep in my
ways. 023:027 For a prostitute is a
deep pit; and a wayward wife is a
narrow well. 023:028 Yes, she lies in
wait like a robber, and increases**

the unfaithful among men. 023:029

Who has woe? Who has sorrow?

Who has strife? Who has

complaints? Who has needless

bruises? Who has bloodshot eyes?

023:030 Those who stay long at the

wine; those who go to seek out

mixed wine. 023:031 Don't look at

the wine when it is red, when it

sparkles in the cup, when it goes

down smoothly. 023:032 In the end,

it bites like a snake, and poisons

like a viper. 023:033 Your eyes will

see strange things, and your mind

will imagine confusing things.

023:034 Yes, you will be as he who

lies down in the midst of the sea, or

as he who lies on top of the rigging:

023:035 "They hit me, and I was not hurt! They beat me, and I don't feel it! When will I wake up? I can do it again. I can find another."

024:001 Don't be envious of evil men; neither desire to be with them: 024:002 for their hearts plot violence, and their lips talk about mischief. 024:003 Through wisdom a house is built; by understanding it is established; 024:004 by knowledge the rooms are filled with all rare and beautiful treasure.

024:005 A wise man has great power; and a knowledgeable man increases strength; 024:006 for by wise guidance you wage your war; and victory is in many advisors.

024:007 Wisdom is too high for a fool: he doesn't open his mouth in the gate. 024:008 One who plots to do evil will be called a schemer.

024:009 The schemes of folly are sin. The mocker is detested by men.

024:010 If you falter in the time of trouble, your strength is small.

024:011 Rescue those who are being led away to death! Indeed, hold back those who are staggering to the slaughter! 024:012 If you say,

"Behold, we didn't know this;" doesn't he who weighs the hearts consider it? He who keeps your soul, doesn't he know it? Shall he not render to every man according to his work? 024:013 My son, eat

honey, for it is good; the droppings of the honeycomb, which are sweet to your taste: 024:014 so you shall know wisdom to be to your soul; if you have found it, then there will be a reward, your hope will not be cut off. 024:015 Don't lay in wait, wicked man, against the habitation of the righteous. Don't destroy his resting place: 024:016 for a righteous man falls seven times, and rises up again; but the wicked are overthrown by calamity. 024:017 Don't rejoice when your enemy falls. Don't let your heart be glad when he is overthrown; 024:018 lest Yahweh see it, and it displease him, and he turn away his

**wrath from him. 024:019 Don't fret
yourself because of evildoers;
neither be envious of the wicked:
024:020 for there will be no reward
to the evil man; and the lamp of the
wicked shall be snuffed out.
024:021 My son, fear Yahweh and
the king. Don't join those who are
rebellious: 024:022 for their
calamity will rise suddenly; the
destruction from them both—who
knows? 024:023 These also are
sayings of the wise. To show
partiality in judgment is not good.
024:024 He who says to the wicked,
"You are righteous;" peoples shall
curse him, and nations shall abhor
him— 024:025 but it will go well**

**with those who convict the guilty,
and a rich blessing will come on
them. 024:026 An honest answer is
like a kiss on the lips. 024:027
Prepare your work outside, and get
your fields ready. Afterwards, build
your house. 024:028 Don't be a
witness against your neighbor
without cause. Don't deceive with
your lips. 024:029 Don't say, "I will
do to him as he has done to me; I
will render to the man according to
his work." 024:030 I went by the
field of the sluggard, by the
vineyard of the man void of
understanding; 024:031 Behold, it
was all grown over with thorns. Its
surface was covered with nettles,**

and its stone wall was broken down. 024:032 Then I saw, and considered well. I saw, and received instruction: 024:033 a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep; 024:034 so shall your poverty come as a robber, and your want as an armed man.

025:001 These also are proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out.

025:002 It is the glory of God to conceal a thing, but the glory of kings is to search out a matter.

025:003 As the heavens for height, and the earth for depth, so the hearts of kings are unsearchable.

025:004 Take away the dross from

**the silver, and material comes out
for the refiner; 025:005 Take away
the wicked from the king's
presence, and his throne will be
established in righteousness.**

**025:006 Don't exalt yourself in the
presence of the king, or claim a
place among great men; 025:007
for it is better that it be said to you,
"Come up here," than that you
should be put lower in the presence
of the prince, whom your eyes have
seen. 025:008 Don't be hasty in
bringing charges to court. What
will you do in the end when your
neighbor shames you? 025:009
Debate your case with your
neighbor, and don't betray the**

confidence of another; 025:010 lest one who hears it put you to shame, and your bad reputation never depart. 025:011 A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in settings of silver. 025:012 As an earring of gold, and an ornament of fine gold, so is a wise reprover to an obedient ear. 025:013 As the cold of snow in the time of harvest, so is a faithful messenger to those who send him; for he refreshes the soul of his masters. 025:014 As clouds and wind without rain, so is he who boasts of gifts deceptively. 025:015 By patience a ruler is persuaded. A soft tongue breaks the bone. 025:016 Have you found honey?

**Eat as much as is sufficient for you,
lest you eat too much, and vomit it.**

**025:017 Let your foot be seldom in
your neighbor's house, lest he be
weary of you, and hate you.**

**025:018 A man who gives false
testimony against his neighbor is
like a club, a sword, or a sharp**

**arrow. 025:019 Confidence in
someone unfaithful in time of
trouble is like a bad tooth, or a**

**lame foot. 025:020 As one who
takes away a garment in cold
weather, or vinegar on soda, so is**

**one who sings songs to a heavy
heart. 025:021 If your enemy is**

**hungry, give him food to eat. If he
is thirsty, give him water to drink:**

025:022 for you will heap coals of fire on his head, and Yahweh will reward you. 025:023 The north wind brings forth rain: so a backbiting tongue brings an angry face. 025:024 It is better to dwell in the corner of the housetop, than to share a house with a contentious woman. 025:025 Like cold water to a thirsty soul, so is good news from a far country. 025:026 Like a muddied spring, and a polluted well, so is a righteous man who gives way before the wicked. 025:027 It is not good to eat much honey; nor is it honorable to seek one's own honor. 025:028 Like a city that is broken down and

without walls is a man whose spirit is without restraint. 026:001 Like snow in summer, and as rain in harvest, so honor is not fitting for a fool. 026:002 Like a fluttering sparrow, like a darting swallow, so the undeserved curse doesn't come to rest. 026:003 A whip is for the horse, a bridle for the donkey, and a rod for the back of fools! 026:004 Don't answer a fool according to his folly, lest you also be like him. 026:005 Answer a fool according to his folly, lest he be wise in his own eyes. 026:006 One who sends a message by the hand of a fool is cutting off feet and drinking violence. 026:007 Like the legs of

the lame that hang loose: so is a parable in the mouth of fools.

026:008 As one who binds a stone in a sling, so is he who gives honor to a fool. 026:009 Like a thornbush that goes into the hand of a drunkard, so is a parable in the mouth of fools. 026:010 As an archer who wounds all, so is he who hires a fool or he who hires those who pass by. 026:011 As a dog that returns to his vomit, so is a fool who repeats his folly. 026:012 Do you see a man wise in his own eyes? There is more hope for a fool than for him. 026:013 The sluggard says, "There is a lion in the road! A fierce lion roams the streets!"

026:014 As the door turns on its hinges, so does the sluggard on his bed. 026:015 The sluggard buries his hand in the dish. He is too lazy to bring it back to his mouth.

026:016 The sluggard is wiser in his own eyes than seven men who answer with discretion. 026:017

Like one who grabs a dog's ears is one who passes by and meddles in a quarrel not his own. 026:018 Like a madman who shoots firebrands, arrows, and death, 026:019 is the man who deceives his neighbor and says, "Am I not joking?" 026:020

For lack of wood a fire goes out.

Without gossip, a quarrel dies down. 026:021 As coals are to hot

embers, and wood to fire, so is a contentious man to kindling strife.

026:022 The words of a whisperer are as dainty morsels, they go down into the innermost parts. 026:023

Like silver dross on an earthen vessel are the lips of a fervent one with an evil heart. 026:024 A

malicious man disguises himself with his lips, but he harbors evil in his heart. 026:025 When his speech is charming, don't believe him; for there are seven abominations in his heart. 026:026 His malice may be concealed by deception, but his wickedness will be exposed in the assembly. 026:027 Whoever digs a pit shall fall into it. Whoever rolls a

stone, it will come back on him.

**026:028 A lying tongue hates those
it hurts; and a flattering mouth**

**works ruin. 027:001 Don't boast
about tomorrow; for you don't
know what a day may bring forth.**

**027:002 Let another man praise
you, and not your own mouth; a
stranger, and not your own lips.**

**027:003 A stone is heavy, and sand
is a burden; but a fool's
provocation is heavier than both.**

**027:004 Wrath is cruel, and anger
is overwhelming; but who is able to
stand before jealousy? 027:005**

**Better is open rebuke than hidden
love. 027:006 Faithful are the**

wounds of a friend; although the

kisses of an enemy are profuse.

**027:007 A full soul loathes a
honeycomb; but to a hungry soul,
every bitter thing is sweet. 027:008**

**As a bird that wanders from her
nest, so is a man who wanders from
his home. 027:009 Perfume and
incense bring joy to the heart; so
does earnest counsel from a man's
friend. 027:010 Don't forsake your
friend and your father's friend.**

**Don't go to your brother's house in
the day of your disaster: better is a
neighbor who is near than a distant
brother. 027:011 Be wise, my son,
and bring joy to my heart, then I
can answer my tormentor. 027:012**

A prudent man sees danger and

takes refuge; but the simple pass on, and suffer for it. 027:013 Take his garment when he puts up collateral for a stranger. Hold it for a wayward woman! 027:014 He who blesses his neighbor with a loud voice early in the morning, it will be taken as a curse by him. 027:015 A continual dropping on a rainy day and a contentious wife are alike: 027:016 restraining her is like restraining the wind, or like grasping oil in his right hand. 027:017 Iron sharpens iron; so a man sharpens his friend's countenance. 027:018 Whoever tends the fig tree shall eat its fruit. He who looks after his master shall

**be honored. 027:019 As water
reflects a face, so a man's heart
reflects the man. 027:020 Sheol and
Abaddon are never satisfied; and a
man's eyes are never satisfied.**

**027:021 The crucible is for silver,
and the furnace for gold; but man
is refined by his praise. 027:022**

**Though you grind a fool in a
mortar with a pestle along with
grain, yet his foolishness will not be
removed from him. 027:023 Know
well the state of your flocks, and
pay attention to your herds:**

**027:024 for riches are not forever,
nor does even the crown endure to
all generations. 027:025 The hay is
removed, and the new growth**

appears, the grasses of the hills are gathered in. 027:026 The lambs are for your clothing, and the goats are the price of a field. 027:027 There will be plenty of goats' milk for your food, for your family's food, and for the nourishment of your servant girls. 028:001 The wicked flee when no one pursues; but the righteous are as bold as a lion. 028:002 In rebellion, a land has many rulers, but order is maintained by a man of understanding and knowledge. 028:003 A needy man who oppresses the poor is like a driving rain which leaves no crops. 028:004 Those who forsake the law praise

**the wicked; but those who keep the
law contend with them. 028:005
Evil men don't understand justice;
but those who seek Yahweh
understand it fully. 028:006 Better
is the poor who walks in his
integrity, than he who is perverse in
his ways, and he is rich. 028:007
Whoever keeps the law is a wise
son; but he who is a companion of
gluttons shames his father. 028:008
He who increases his wealth by
excessive interest gathers it for one
who has pity on the poor. 028:009
He who turns away his ear from
hearing the law, even his prayer is
an abomination. 028:010 Whoever
causes the upright to go astray in**

an evil way, he will fall into his own trap; but the blameless will inherit good. 028:011 The rich man is wise in his own eyes; but the poor who has understanding sees through him. 028:012 When the righteous triumph, there is great glory; but when the wicked rise, men hide themselves. 028:013 He who conceals his sins doesn't prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them finds mercy. 028:014 Blessed is the man who always fears; but one who hardens his heart falls into trouble. 028:015 As a roaring lion or a charging bear, so is a wicked ruler over helpless people. 028:016 A

**tyrannical ruler lacks judgment.
One who hates ill-gotten gain will
have long days. 028:017 A man who
is tormented by life blood will be a
fugitive until death; no one will
support him. 028:018 Whoever
walks blamelessly is kept safe; but
one with perverse ways will fall
suddenly. 028:019 One who works
his land will have an abundance of
food; but one who chases fantasies
will have his fill of poverty. 028:020
A faithful man is rich with
blessings; but one who is eager to
be rich will not go unpunished.
028:021 To show partiality is not
good; yet a man will do wrong for a
piece of bread. 028:022 A stingy**

**man hurries after riches, and
doesn't know that poverty waits for
him. 028:023 One who rebukes a
man will afterward find more favor
than one who flatters with the
tongue. 028:024 Whoever robs his
father or his mother, and says, "It's
not wrong." He is a partner with a
destroyer. 028:025 One who is
greedy stirs up strife; but one who
trusts in Yahweh will prosper.
028:026 One who trusts in himself
is a fool; but one who walks in
wisdom is kept safe. 028:027 One
who gives to the poor has no lack;
but one who closes his eyes will
have many curses. 028:028 When
the wicked rise, men hide**

**themselves; but when they perish,
the righteous thrive. 029:001 He
who is often rebuked and stiffens
his neck will be destroyed suddenly,
with no remedy. 029:002 When the
righteous thrive, the people rejoice;
but when the wicked rule, the
people groan. 029:003 Whoever
loves wisdom brings joy to his
father; but a companion of
prostitutes squanders his wealth.
029:004 The king by justice makes
the land stable, but he who takes
bribes tears it down. 029:005 A
man who flatters his neighbor
spreads a net for his feet. 029:006
An evil man is snared by his sin,
but the righteous can sing and be**

glad. 029:007 The righteous care about justice for the poor. The wicked aren't concerned about knowledge. 029:008 Mockers stir up a city, but wise men turn away anger. 029:009 If a wise man goes to court with a foolish man, the fool rages or scoffs, and there is no peace. 029:010 The bloodthirsty hate a man of integrity; and they seek the life of the upright. 029:011 A fool vents all of his anger, but a wise man brings himself under control. 029:012 If a ruler listens to lies, all of his officials are wicked. 029:013 The poor man and the oppressor have this in common: Yahweh gives sight to the eyes of

both. 029:014 The king who fairly judges the poor, his throne shall be established forever. 029:015 The rod of correction gives wisdom, but a child left to himself causes shame to his mother. 029:016 When the wicked increase, sin increases; but the righteous will see their downfall. 029:017 Correct your son, and he will give you peace; yes, he will bring delight to your soul. 029:018 Where there is no revelation, the people cast off restraint; but one who keeps the law is blessed. 029:019 A servant can't be corrected by words. Though he understands, yet he will not respond. 029:020 Do you see a

man who is hasty in his words?

**There is more hope for a fool than
for him. 029:021 He who pampers
his servant from youth will have
him become a son in the end.**

**029:022 An angry man stirs up
strife, and a wrathful man abounds
in sin. 029:023 A man's pride
brings him low, but one of lowly
spirit gains honor. 029:024**

**Whoever is an accomplice of a thief
is an enemy of his own soul. He
takes an oath, but dares not testify.
029:025 The fear of man proves to
be a snare, but whoever puts his
trust in Yahweh is kept safe.**

**029:026 Many seek the ruler's
favor, but a man's justice comes**

from Yahweh. 029:027 A dishonest man detests the righteous, and the upright in their ways detest the wicked. 030:001 The words of Agur the son of Jakeh, the oracle: the man says to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal: 030:002 "Surely I am the most ignorant man, and don't have a man's understanding. 030:003 I have not learned wisdom, neither do I have the knowledge of the Holy One. 030:004 Who has ascended up into heaven, and descended? Who has gathered the wind in his fists? Who has bound the waters in his garment? Who has established all the ends of the earth? What is his name, and what

is his son's name, if you know?

**030:005 "Every word of God is
flawless. He is a shield to those who
take refuge in him. 030:006 Don't
you add to his words, lest he
reprove you, and you be found a
liar. 030:007 "Two things I have
asked of you; don't deny me before
I die: 030:008 Remove far from me
falsehood and lies. Give me neither
poverty nor riches. Feed me with
the food that is needful for me;
030:009 lest I be full, deny you, and
say, 'Who is Yahweh?' or lest I be
poor, and steal, and so dishonor the
name of my God. 030:010 "Don't
slander a servant to his master, lest
he curse you, and you be held**

guilty. 030:011 There is a generation that curses their father, and doesn't bless their mother.

030:012 There is a generation that is pure in their own eyes, yet are not washed from their filthiness.

030:013 There is a generation, oh how lofty are their eyes! Their eyelids are lifted up. 030:014 There is a generation whose teeth are like swords, and their jaws like knives, to devour the poor from the earth, and the needy from among men.

030:015 "The leach has two daughters: 'Give, give.' "There are three things that are never satisfied; four that don't say, 'Enough:' 030:016 Sheol, the

**barren womb; the earth that is not
satisfied with water; and the fire
that doesn't say, 'Enough.' 030:017**

**"The eye that mocks at his father,
and scorns obedience to his**

**mother: the ravens of the valley
shall pick it out, the young eagles
shall eat it. 030:018 "There are**

**three things which are too amazing
for me, four which I don't**

**understand: 030:019 The way of an
eagle in the air; the way of a
serpent on a rock; the way of a ship
in the midst of the sea; and the way
of a man with a maiden. 030:020**

**"So is the way of an adulterous
woman: she eats and wipes her
mouth, and says, 'I have done**

nothing wrong.' 030:021 "For three things the earth tremble, and under four, it can't bear up: 030:022 For a servant when he is king; a fool when he is filled with food; 030:023 for an unloved woman when she is married; and a handmaid who is heir to her mistress. 030:024

"There are four things which are little on the earth, but they are exceedingly wise: 030:025 the ants are not a strong people, yet they provide their food in the summer. 030:026 The conies are but a feeble folk, yet make they their houses in the rocks. 030:027 The locusts have no king, yet they advance in ranks. 030:028 You can catch a lizard with

**your hands, yet it is in kings'
palaces. 030:029 "There are three
things which are stately in their
march, four which are stately in
going: 030:030 The lion, which is
mightiest among animals, and
doesn't turn away for any; 030:031
the greyhound, the male goat also;
and the king against whom there is
no rising up. 030:032 "If you have
done foolishly in lifting up yourself,
or if you have thought evil, put
your hand over your mouth.
030:033 For as the churning of milk
brings forth butter, and the
wringing of the nose brings forth
blood; so the forcing of wrath
brings forth strife." 031:001 The**

**words of king Lemuel; the oracle
which his mother taught him.**

**031:002 "Oh, my son! Oh, son of
my womb! Oh, son of my vows!**

**031:003 Don't give your strength to
women, nor your ways to that
which destroys kings. 031:004 It is
not for kings, Lemuel; it is not for
kings to drink wine; nor for princes
to say, 'Where is strong drink?'**

**031:005 lest they drink, and forget
the law, and pervert the justice due
to anyone who is afflicted. 031:006**

**Give strong drink to him who is
ready to perish; and wine to the
bitter in soul: 031:007 Let him
drink, and forget his poverty, and
remember his misery no more.**

031:008 Open your mouth for the mute, in the cause of all who are left desolate. 031:009 Open your mouth, judge righteously, and serve justice to the poor and needy."

031:010 {Proverbs 31:10-31 form an acrostic, with each verse starting with each letter of the Hebrew alphabet, in order.} Who can find a worthy woman? For her price is far above rubies. 031:011 The heart of her husband trusts in her. He shall have no lack of gain. 031:012 She does him good, and not harm, all the days of her life. 031:013 She seeks wool and flax, and works eagerly with her hands. 031:014 She is like the merchant ships. She

**brings her bread from afar. 031:015
She rises also while it is yet night,
gives food to her household, and
portions for her servant girls.**

**031:016 She considers a field, and
buys it. With the fruit of her hands,
she plants a vineyard. 031:017 She
girds her waist with strength, and
makes her arms strong. 031:018**

**She perceives that her merchandise
is profitable. Her lamp doesn't go
out by night. 031:019 She lays her
hands to the distaff, and her hands
hold the spindle. 031:020 She opens
her arms to the poor; yes, she
extends her hands to the needy.**

**031:021 She is not afraid of the
snow for her household; for all her**

household are clothed with scarlet.

**031:022 She makes for herself
carpets of tapestry. Her clothing is**

**fine linen and purple. 031:023 Her
husband is respected in the gates,**

when he sits among the elders of

**the land. 031:024 She makes linen
garments and sells them, and**

delivers sashes to the merchant.

031:025 Strength and dignity are

her clothing. She laughs at the time

to come. 031:026 She opens her

mouth with wisdom. Faithful

instruction is on her tongue.

**031:027 She looks well to the ways
of her household, and doesn't eat**

the bread of idleness. 031:028 Her

children rise up and call her

blessed. Her husband also praises her: 031:029 "Many women do noble things, but you excel them all." 031:030 Charm is deceitful, and beauty is vain; but a woman who fears Yahweh, she shall be praised. 031:031 Give her of the fruit of her hands! Let her works praise her in the gates!

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